



Kaspar Houser: Summary

Kaspar Houser was a boy from Nuremberg who had spent about 16 years (1812-1828) of his early age in a cell under the custody of an intoxicated poor laborer, who appeared to have been his keeper. The jail period had not only affected his linguistic ability but also deformed his bone structure of feet and knees. He could only speak two words: "Bua" for people and "ross" for animals. However, he was able to speak incoherently, missing the conjunctions, participles and adverbs. The syntax of his sentences was also confusing. For example, 'Kaspar very well', instead of 'I am very well'.

In 1829, he started living with Herr Daumier's family and had improved his reading and writing a lot. He decided to write his memoirs and started writing but couldn't complete the project as someone tried to kill him but he survived the attack. In 1833, a stranger stabbed him in a park and he died after three days.

Summary: Otzi the Iceman

In 1991, someone found the frozen mummy of a Copper Age man who climbed up to the icy mountains of the Schnalstal glacier over 5000 years ago and died. Since March 1998 the mummy and its articles, after the complete examination, have been on display at the South Tyrol Museum of Archaeology. The first ever anatomical studies were performed on a glacier mummy of the 4th millennium BC. Only the left hip area was found damaged. The iceman, with his equipment and clothing, shows the lifestyle and the general appearance of an Alps person during the Copper Age. The clothing, composed of a cap, hide coat, grass cloak, leggings, belt, loincloth and a pair of shoes, remarkably contains no woven materials. The necessary equipment of the iceman made him able to look after himself in his last trip into the high mountains. He could repair and replace any damaged piece of equipment. The mummy of the iceman is preserved at -6°C in one of the two identical cold chambers with independent refrigeration systems. Visitors can view the mummy from the examination room through a window. (185 words)

Summary: The Extinction Crisis

In the history of biological diversity, the human species are destroying many other species hundreds of times faster than the old rate of extinction. The major causes are the increasing human population and the consumption of resources. Climate change and collision of meteors with the earth are other causes of extinction. The way humans are destroying, degrading and fragmenting the habitat of other species, it will be difficult for new species to evolve. Humans should realize that they heavily depend on plants and animals for food, medicines, clothing and shelter. The intact ecosystem is helpful for purifying the air, filtering harmful substances out of the water. An ecosystem with more species is better than one that has lost some species and the keystone species are very important to the health of their ecosystems.

In many cultures, certain animals are very significant in terms of not only their religious importance but also the way they entertain us. Most people want to save other species as they are now much worried about the decline of wildlife. The wildlife laws area also now protecting animals from their illegal hunting. As a result, humans are also now too concerned about all kinds of animals irrespective of their economic value.

Summary: Mars Exploration Why not send People

People are not being sent to Mars because of some significant reasons. The first reason is our bad track record of sending fewer than one third successful probes out of more than 30 robotic probes towards Mars. The second reason is cost. It is estimated that more than 100 billion dollars will be required to send a small team of people to Mars. Last but not least, the reason is the engineering challenges which include the fuel production for the return flight and the cosmic radiation that astronauts would absorb during such a long mission.

Summary: Want to know what 3-g feels like

The writer begins the article with a reference to funfairs because there is a circular ride there that spins very fast. And the subject of the article is also about a 58-foot diameter centrifuge. But the centrifuge even spins much faster than the carnival ride. So, the writer, by giving the reference of the carnival ride, tries to get the attention of his readers. His goal is to learn how humans adjust to changes in strong gravity. NASA is interested because it's not just microgravity that astronauts experience in space but they are exposed to hyper gravity, too. One of the physical effects of hyper gravity is that fluid weighs more under the conditions of hyper gravity. The heart pumps faster than usual and works harder to push the blood all the way to the brain. This could cause astronauts to become dizzy or even, in extreme cases, to pass out. By spinning people in his centrifuge, Cohen hopes to learn whether the heart's response can be conditioned. Artificial gravity could prevent the physical problems caused by microgravity but it is not a universal panacea. The problem is when you spin a small centrifuge, fitted in a spaceship, pretty fast, g levels change rapidly. Therefore, it does not solve all the problems of microgravity in a spaceship.

Summary: Boy, do fathers make a difference!

This article highlights the importance of fathers. The fathers of today are far better than that of 25 years ago. They make the family a strong unit because of the sacrifice they give in the form of giving their valuable time to their children. The problem is that the family in which children miss the company of their father feel anxiety and stress. The children living with their estranged rich mother but without having the company of their father are found disturbed. But the children living with their poor but both of the parents i.e., mother and father are found happy. Fathers can better handle and control their sons than mothers. Different studies show that boys commit crimes in the absence of their fathers and ultimately go to jail. All fathers should be given paternity leave. In this way a close bond will develop among the members of a family. And a father and his son will especially remove the barriers between them. A family is definitely more important than a career. In this regard, the company owner should realize that their male workers are also fathers with obligations to their families. And fathers should also be ready to sacrifice for their families when their career becomes a hurdle before their families.

Summary: The Beggars Baby

The writing is about a beggar's sick girl about whom James Fenton was unnecessarily too worried to help save her with the number one treatment by a number one doctor in the number one hospital. He was assuming and predicting things too early. He wanted to take the sick baby girl to the best hospital in the locality. Then the writer hired a taxi to take the sick child to the best hospital. When they were on the way to hospital, they faced many problems. First, the taxi ran out of petrol. Second, a van blocked their way as it stopped in front of their taxi. Third, a train had to pass very soon through a level-crossing on their way. Fourth, they were hit by the side-effects of Typhoon Sarah. Fifth, their tyre split but they noticed it later. Last but not least, the driver couldn't drive fast in the cloudburst. The people were upset but willing to help save the sick baby girl. The writer himself went into the hotel and asked the girl at reception to call a doctor. He asked her to call the doctor for the sick baby girl but she didn't agree to do that. The author argued with her and tried to convince her but all in vain. The author did so because he was too worried about the critical condition of the sick baby girl. During the journey to the hospital, Fenton imagined and sketched the hospital in his mind like a large cool building equipped with some latest equipment. But they reached at the clinic of a Vietnamese quack. Fenton distrusted the Vietnamese doctor and was panicking before her treatment. He didn't trust the local herbal treatment but, to his amazement, the sick baby got instant relief from the herbal treatment and recovered in no time. Fenton, now, felt humiliated and had never been more furious in his life before that particular moment.

Summary: On Vacation with Father

In the back of the car, the children made a firecracker by uniting a bunch of match sticks. Then they would explode the firecracker by throwing it before cars following behind them. It was like a bomb blast. The drivers get surprised and year their cars in an amusing fashion. Their father remained ignorant of their mischief because he was miles away up front from his children in the back of the car. Furthermore, he was driving very carefully and couldn't notice their mischief. Bryson says that his father's meanness on vacations was due to his principal obsession with trying to economize. Example 1. He always took us to the crummiest hotels and motor lodges, and to the kind of roadside eating-houses where they only washed the dishes weekly Example 2. Usually, we were forced to picnic by the side of the road. My father had an instinct for picking bad picnic sites- - These two examples forcefully affect the reader and he couldn't help laughing. The passage, "On Vacation with Father", presents both good and bad sides of the image of America. The bad picnic places mentioned in the passage show the bad image of America. The last paragraph of the passage creates a beautiful image of America by presenting the scenic beauty of America. In this phrase, "bitterness" means an uneasiness that prevailed in the car. All the members of the family were tense and upset. And by "unquenched basic needs" means that the children showed dissatisfaction regarding the cheap quality of the foodstuff ordered by their father.

Summary: Don't put mothers behind bars

Intermittent Custody is a scheme launched for prisoners in prisons of England to spend their imprisonment time "home and away". It means that prisoners will be allowed to spend some certain days of the week as imprisonment at their homes. The prison system is facing the most important problem of inmate suicide and this is a crucial problem especially in women's prisons, it was shocking that sixty percent more women killed themselves in 2003 than did in 2002. Women are predominant victims of the problem of inmate suicide. The reasons for women's self-destructive behavior in prison are that those women were mentally unstable and traumatized by domestic and / or sexual violence. The writer says that these reasons miss the point because the real causes of inmate suicide are cognitive disarray, lack of the mental resilience to cope with incarceration and above all the responsibility of childcare on the part of women. Zoe Williams is suggesting that the mothers who have been convicted of a minor or non-violent crime should be sent to the sewing circle for the completion of their punishment.

Summary: Molly Kelly

Molly Kelly was born Molly Craig in 1917, at Igalong, on the edge of the Gibson Desert. Her father, Thomas Craig, was an English-born fence inspector but her mother was from the Mardudjara people, a primitive race (Aborigine) of Australia. The Australian authorities considered the Aborigine race inferior to the white race and started separating them from each other, Aborigines were made slaves and servants of the white race. Therefore, Molly Kelly was sent, with her younger sister and cousin, to a bleak government institution to be trained as a domestic servant. But she was able to escape from the tight security of the government institution. Her long journey back towards home was on foot. She lost her cousin on the way but came back with her sister eventually. In 1940, she was again taken to the Moore River Native Settlement. She ran away again in 1941, carrying her 18-month-old daughter Annabelle, but leaving her four-year-old, Doris, in the care of a relative. In 1943, Annabelle was taken away from her because she was white and she refused to live with her aboriginal mother and never saw her again. Then her daughter, Doris, was sent to a Christian mission where she was brought up to believe that her mother had deliberately abandoned her when she was just four-year-old. In 1962, she traced her mother and discovered the truth that the Australian authorities were liars and guilty. In fact, they had treated her mother very cruelly just for her Aboriginal background. Subsequently, she wrote the book *Follow the Rabbit-Proof Fence* to highlight her mother's great struggle against racial prejudices.

Summary: Pho, Hanoi's noodle soup

Pho, Hanoi's noodle soup, is one of the world's best breakfasts. It is so because the north Vietnamese consider the noodle soup- pho as "the soul of the nation", "a contribution to human happiness" and an addiction worse than tobacco. The best way to find the best pho stall is to search for a stall with a large crowd round it. The writer, on this principle, found Thao Van's portable restaurant by Dong Xuan market in the city, Hanoi. Pho gained its name from the French word feu which means fire. It may have come with the French colonialists from *coffre-feu* which means a portable stove. And a portable stove is used for pho. You are supposed to eat pho fast otherwise in five minutes the noodles become waterlogged and lose their texture. Street pho stalls are outlawed in modern Vietnam and are called guerrilla restaurants because they are small units, highly mobile, make an impact and then move out fast. Therefore, stools used for eating pho are dwarf-sized as they are easy to carry while running away quickly at the time of the sudden raid or arrival of police.

Summary: First Moments in Prison

As soon as the cell door is slammed behind him, a first-time prisoner feels loneliness and starts looking round the cell. He thinks to observe his new place carefully and look at especially the available objects to be used there. Then he thinks to escape that narrow cell. He thinks he should try to pull himself up by the iron bars of the window and look out. He fails to pull himself up but doesn't lose heart and decides to practice and master the art of pulling himself up by his hands. He thinks to deceive the guard standing at the cell door. The guard keeps on peeping in through the spy-hole to watch the prisoner's activities. After spending a few days in such strict security, he realizes how difficult it is to run away from that cell. The outside world loses its reality for him and it becomes a dream world.

